Sullivan County, Tennessee
AMERICANS WITH DISABILITIES ACT
2018 - 2028 ADA Transition Plan

The main purpose of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Transition Plan is to develop policies and practices for implementing physical improvements for all Sullivan County publicly owned and operated facilities open to the public and its employees including pedestrian access to such spaces and within its public rights-of-way. The Transition Plan provides for an implementation schedule of such facilities to ensure compliance with the Federal, State and local regulations and standards.

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Prepared for the Sullivan County Mayor and Board of County Commissioners
October 17, 2019
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1 | OVERIVEW OF THE FEDERAL REQUIREMENTS

Introduction

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) is a civil rights law that mandates equal opportunity for individuals with disabilities. The ADA prohibits discrimination in access to jobs, public accommodations, government services, public transportation and telecommunications. Sullivan County has performed a self-assessment of all facilities and services over the past year in order to prepare the ADA Transition Plan and Implementation Schedule for Compliance.

The following seeks to implement a plan that benefits the citizens and county employees of Sullivan County. This plan describes the process developed to complete the Self-Assessment and Evaluation Study for all county activities, facilities and programs on public land and public rights-of-way within Sullivan County to ensure accessibility to all.

The purposes of this document shall be to itemize the facilities along with the ranking of priorities to be addresses as well as serve as a guide for the ADA Coordinator for the implementation schedule and needs for repairs, renovations and improvements by facility. All future renovations shall include the priorities outlined in the Self-Assessment Facilities Study.

Excerpts from the Americans with Disabilities Act

The American with Disabilities Act (ADA) was approved by the Federal government in 1990 (and updated periodically) to ensure that people with disabilities are not discriminated against. The definition of disabled is "a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities: including someone who is disabled through a record of an impairment, is regarded as having an impairment, or is associated with someone who has a disability.

The ADA includes:

> **Title I**: Employees with disabilities are treated fairly in all areas including hiring, testing, discipline, benefits, use of leave.
>
> **Title II**: All services, programs and activities are accessible to all when viewed in entirety.

Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 prohibits discrimination based on disability by any program or activity receiving Federal financial assistance. Discrimination may consist of exclusion from participation in or denial of the benefits of programs and activities operated by a department,

agency or other form of State or Local government. Section 504 applies to Sullivan County, Tennessee as well as all sub-recipients of Federal funds.

The American with Disabilities Act (ADA) of 1990 lends further protection on the basis established by Section 504 by prohibiting discrimination, based on disability by public entities regardless of whether they receive Federal financial assistance. The Act is divided into five titles describing requirements related to:

1) **Employment;**
2) **State and local government services;**
3) **Public accommodations;**
4) **Telecommunications;**
5) **Miscellaneous provisions**

Appendices A through C to Part 35 – Guidance to Revisions to ADA Regulation on Nondiscrimination based on Disability of the Act, specifically applies to State and local government services and the programs and activities they administer – including items built before and after 1990. Public entities with fifty (50) or more employees must develop a transition plan that identifies areas that need (or may need) any structural changes to meet program compliance. Excerpt from the Code of Federal Register (CFR):

(d) Transition plan. (1) In the event that structural changes to facilities will be undertaken to achieve program accessibility, a public entity that employs 50 or more persons shall develop, within six months of January 26, 1992, a transition plan setting forth the steps necessary to complete such changes. A public entity shall provide an opportunity to interested persons, including individuals with disabilities or organizations representing individuals with disabilities, to participate in the development of the transition plan by submitting comments. A copy of the transition plan shall be made available for public inspection.

(2) If a public entity has responsibility or authority over streets, roads, or walkways, its transition plan shall include a schedule for providing curb ramps or other sloped areas where pedestrian walks cross curbs, giving priority to walkways serving entities covered by the Act, including State and local government offices and facilities, transportation, places of public accommodation, and employers, followed by walkways serving other areas.

At a minimum, the Plan must meet the requirements stated in 28 Code of Federal Register (CFR) 35.150(d) as follows:

1) Identify physical obstacles in the County's facilities that limit the accessibility of its programs or activities to individuals with disabilities;
2) Describe the methods that will be used to make the facilities accessible;
3) Specify the schedule for taking the steps necessary to achieve compliance; and
4) Indicate the official(s) responsible for implementation of the ADA Transition Plan.

Public entities responsible for streets, roads, sidewalks, loading areas, and parking lots managed by the County shall include a schedule for providing improvements needed for ADA Compliance, as identified in the Self-Assessment Study. The 23 CFR 35.15(d)(2) sets forth the priority listing for such exterior improvements.

2 | *A CALL TO ACTION*

ADA Statement - Sullivan County does not discriminate based on disability in admission to, access to, or operations of its programs, services, or activities. Sullivan County does not discriminate based on disability in its hiring or employment practices.

1) *Sullivan County has identified the obstacles in County facilities as noted in the 2018 Self-Assessment Facilities Study;*
2) *Such study was conducted by a reputable local architectural firm per the Federal Guidelines;*
3) *Pursuant adoption of this Transition Plan described herein, Sullivan County shall outline the timeline of ADA compliance measures and identify steps to mediate the areas out of compliance as identified in the Self-Assessment;*
4) *The ADA Coordinator shall be responsible for implementing the ADA Transition Plan as adopted.*

DECLARATION OF COMPLIANCE WITH THE AMERCIANS WITH DISABILITIES ACT

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) requires that private organizations serving the public make their goods, services and facilities accessible to people with disabilities. Furthermore, Sullivan County requires that all its Contractors comply with their ADA obligations and verify such compliance by signing this Declaration of Compliance. The Contractor certifies that it will comply with the ADA by:

- Adopting policies, practices and procedures that ensure non-discrimination and equal access to Contractor's goods, service and facilities for people with disabilities;
- Providing goods, services and facilities to individuals with disabilities in an integrated setting, except when separate programs are required to ensure equal access;
- Making reasonable modifications in programs, activities and services when necessary to ensure equal access to individuals with disabilities, unless fundamental alteration in the nature of the Contractor's program would result;
- Removing architectural barriers in existing facilities or providing alternative means of delivering goods and services when removal of barriers is cost-prohibitive;
- Furnishing auxiliary aids to ensure equally effective communication with person with disabilities; and
- If contractor provides transportation to the public, by providing equivalent accessible transportation to people with disabilities.

(Such language shall be inserted into any contract the Purchasing Agent authorizes for such work on county buildings, services and facilities)

Background for Compliance and Planning

Pursuant Title 28 of the Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Chapter 1, Part 35 – NONDESCRIMINATION ON THE BASIS OF DISABILITY IN STATE AND LOCAL GOVERNMENT SERVICES: Sullivan County, Tennessee has undergone a Comprehensive Self-Assessment of all county-owned and operated facilities within its jurisdiction. In November of 2017, The Mayor and Board of County Commissioners formally adopted by Resolution No. 2017-11-88, its full commitment to moving forward with the necessary Self-Evaluation and ADA Transition Plan work. In addition, the ADA Coordinator position was officially appointed to the County Buildings & Maintenance Supervisor as he/she will continue to oversee the renovation, maintenance and upgrades to all county-owned and operated facilities in accordance with the ADA regulations. In addition, the Mayor and Board of County Commissioners authorized the approval of contracting with a local architectural firm, who was well-proven to be competent and knowledgeable to perform the full self-assessment study of such County facilities. This work was performed during the summer months of 2018 with the full Self-Assessment documentation and Comprehensive Study completed in November of 2018. The ADA Transition Plan is intended to guide the County's efforts to provide an accessible transportation system and facilities plan within its jurisdiction. Such facilities identified in this plan include all County-Owned and Operated public office buildings, grounds, parks, out-buildings, maintenance buildings, historical structures, sidewalks and parking lots. {For purposes of this plan, the buildings owned and/or operated by the Sullivan County Department of Education shall be included in a separate ADA Transition Plan authored and managed by the Department of Education}. Both plans shall be subject to the necessary public comment period for review prior to formal adoption by the County. The purpose of the plan is to identify deficiencies in the County's policies, procedures and physical assets. The plan also provides guidance for removal of accessibility barriers to the public and employees. The plan shall be updated regularly to reflect the on-going renovations and improvements to such facilities as budgeted and scheduled to ensure ADA compliance going forward.

Sullivan County ADA Transition Plan addresses the plan requirements relating to physical assets, including facilities and rights-of-way owned and maintained by the County. Facilities are defined to include any County office or maintenance buildings. Public Rights-of-Way features include, but are not limited to, curb ramps, sidewalks within the public rights-of-way or in and around County buildings, crosswalks, median crossings and pedestrian activated signal systems. Currently the County does not own or operate any pedestrian activities signal systems. Public sidewalks are currently limited to areas in and around the Blountville and Piney Flats Historical Districts as well as approach areas around public buildings. The 2018 awarded Tennessee Department of Transportation: Multimodal Access Grant for Blountville's downtown, shall address all facilities within

the rights-of-way of the Highway 126/Great Stage Road corridor of the Blountville Historic District to ensure ADA compliance.

The County must provide an opportunity to interested persons, including individuals with disabilities or organizations representing individuals with disabilities, to participate in the development of the ADA Transition Plan by submitting comments. A copy of the Draft ADA Transition Plan shall be made available for public inspection [pursuant 28 CFR 35.15 (d)(1)]. For questions or comments prior to the adoption of the Plan, please contact the Planning & Codes Department or the ADA Coordinator's office.

3 | GRIEVANCE PROCEDURES

This Grievance Procedure is established to meet the requirements of the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990 and the ADA Amendments Act of 2008. It may be used to file a complaint alleging discrimination based on disability of the employee, in the provision of services, activities, programs, or benefits provided by the Sullivan County local government∗

∗ **County Employees:** A complaint by a county employee alleging discrimination based on *disability pertaining to employment with the county* will be processed pursuant to the County Handbook provided to each county employee upon hire during the New Hire appointment with the Sullivan County Payroll Manager. All ADA accessibility complaints should be submitted to the Sullivan County Payroll Manager. The complaint should be in writing and contain information about the alleged discrimination such as name, address, phone number of grievant and location, date, and description of the problem. Alternative means of filing complaints, e.g., personal interviews, recording of the complaint, etc. will be made available for persons with disabilities upon request. The complaint should be submitted by the grievant or designee as soon as possible but no later than sixty (60) calendar days after the alleged violation to:

Sullivan County Historic Courthouse - Payroll Department:
3411 Hwy. 126, Suite 202, Blountville, TN 37617
Email: ADAcontact@sullivancountytn.gov
(423) 323-6413

Within fifteen (15) calendar days after receipt of the complaint, the Payroll Manager and the ADA Coordinator or designee will offer to meet with the grievant to discuss the complaint and possible resolutions. This meeting can occur either in person, over the phone, electronically, or in any format agreeable to the grievant, the ADA Coordinator and the Payroll Manager. Within fifteen (15) calendar days after the meeting, the ADA Coordinator or designee will respond in writing, in a format accessible to the grievant, and will explain the position of the county and may offer other options for substantive resolution of the complaint.

If the response by the ADA Coordinator or designee does not satisfactorily resolve the issue, the grievant or designee may appeal the decision within fifteen (15) calendar days after receipt of the response to the County Mayor. Within fifteen (15) calendar days after receipt of the appeal, the County Mayor or designee will offer to meet with the grievant to discuss the complaint and possible resolutions. This meeting can occur either in person, over the phone, electronically, or in any format agreeable to the grievant County Mayor. Within fifteen (15) calendar days after the meeting, the County Mayor or designee will respond in writing, in a format accessible to the grievant, with a final decision of the County regarding the complaint. All written complaints and responses (made or received) will be retained by Sullivan County for at least three (3) years.

NOTICE UNDER THE AMERICANS WITH DISABILITIES ACT FOR SULLIVAN COUNTY, TN

In accordance with the requirements of title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990 ("ADA"), the **Sullivan County, Tennessee** will not discriminate against qualified individuals with disabilities based on disability in its services, programs, or activities.

Employment: **Sullivan County** does not discriminate based on any disability in its hiring or employment practices and complies with all regulations promulgated by the U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission under title I of the ADA.

Effective Communication: **Sullivan County** will generally, upon request, provide appropriate aids and services leading to effective communication for qualified persons with disabilities so they can participate equally in **Sullivan County** programs, services, and activities, including qualified sign language interpreters, documents in Braille, and other ways of making information and communications accessible to people who have speech, hearing, or vision impairments.

Modifications to Policies and Procedures: **Sullivan County** will make all reasonable modifications to policies and programs to ensure that people with disabilities have an equal opportunity to enjoy all its programs, services, and activities. For example, individuals with service animals are welcomed in **Sullivan County** offices, even where pets are generally prohibited.

Anyone who requires an auxiliary aid or service for effective communication, or a modification of policies or procedures to participate in a program, service, or activity of **Sullivan County** should contact the office of the County's ADA Coordinator as soon as possible but no later than 48 hours before the scheduled event.

Cindy Stewart (423) 323-6405 or ADAContact@sullivancountytn.gov
Sullivan County Maintenance Building, 3411 Highway 126, Blountville, TN 37671

The ADA does not require the **Sullivan County** to take any action that would fundamentally alter the nature of its programs or services or impose an undue financial or administrative burden.

Complaints that a program, service, or activity of Sullivan County is not accessible to persons with disabilities should be directed to ***Cindy Stewart, ADA Coordinator.***

Sullivan County will not place a surcharge on a particular individual with a disability or any group of individuals with disabilities to cover the cost of providing auxiliary aids/services or reasonable modifications of policy, such as retrieving items from locations that are open to the public but are not accessible to persons who use wheelchairs.

Request for ADA Grievance Resolution Form
Sullivan County, Tennessee

Date: _____

I, _____, am filing a complaint alleging discrimination on the basis of disability in the provision of services, activities, programs, or benefits by Sullivan County, Tennessee

STATEMENT OF GRIEVANCE

Date of Complaint:	
Location of Complaint:	
Names of Involved Parties:	
Nature of Complaint Detailing Specific events (including any documentation that may support your grievance):	
Prior Attempts to Resolve (please indicate any previous efforts to resolve your complaint including dates and parties involved):	
Resolution Sought (please provide a clear statement that reflects the resolution you believe will satisfy your complaint):	
Name of Individual (Grievant):	
Print Name:	
Signature:	
Mail or Email a copy of this form and copies of any supporting documentation to: ADAcontact@sullivancountytn.gov	Sullivan County Payroll Department 3411 Highway 126, Suite 202 Blountville, TN 37617

Sullivan County, Tennessee

AMERICANS WITH DISABILITIES ACT

ADA COORDINATOR, 3419 Highway 126, Blountville, TN 37617
Email Coordinator: ADAcontact@sullivancountytn.gov

REQUEST FOR ACCOMMODATION OR BARRIER REMOVAL

Check One: ___**Accommodation** ___**Barrier Removal**

Name of Complainant:

_____

Last MI First

Address:

_____

City: _____ State: _____ Zip: _____

Telephone No.: _____ Email: _____

Preferred Method of Contact: (*Check all that apply*)
___Voice Telephone ___TTY ___CRS ___Email ___US Mail ___ Other: _____

Accommodation needed or location of barrier:

_____
_____
_____
_____

Brief statement of why the accommodation is needed or the barrier removed:

_____
_____
_____
_____

Date accommodation is needed: _____

Certification: I certify that I have a disability or medical condition that required reasonable accommodation, which will be met by acquiring the equipment, services or work adjustments described above.

Signature: _____ Date: _____

If person needing accommodation is not the individual completing this form, please provide:

Representative's Name: _____

Address: _____

Telephone No.: _____

For more information or assistance in completing the form, please contact the ADA Coordinator

Office Direct # (423) 323-6405 or ADAcontact@sullivancountytn.gov

4 | FACILITY SELF-ASSESSMENT:

FINDINGS FOR EACH FACILITY BY PRIORITY AND SCHEUDLE

Sullivan County contracted with a reputable local architectural firm to prepare the comprehensive Self-Assessment and Evaluation of all county owned and operated public facilities, services and programs. Each facility study included a summary of the findings categorized by priorities 1, 2, 3, and 4.

Priority One: The highest priority is placed on those barrier removal items that provide accessibility to the main entrance of any facility or improve a path of travel to the portion of the facility where program activities take place; parking, walks, ramps, stairs, doors and corridors. It is the intent of the Transition Plan and Implementation Schedule to address these items first depending on the immediate necessity, degree of complexity and overall costs. Buildings, such as the Historic Courthouse and Justice Centers will be given top priority as they receive the most customers on a daily basis. Historical structures not being used for county offices and only open on a limited basis will be given a lower priority with regards to a timeline for corrective improvements.

Priority Two: A second level of priority is placed on those barrier removal items that improve or enhance access to program use areas; meeting rooms, public offices and restrooms. Such items will also be implemented for compliance based upon the immediate necessity, degree of complexity and overall costs to fix.

Priority Three: The third level of priority found in the Self-Assessment and Evolution Study was placed on those barrier removal items that improve access to amenities serving program areas; telephones, site furnishing snack vending machines for example. These items, if found necessary shall be remedied based upon a need, cost and location. Those used in the high-traffic areas such as the courthouse and courtrooms shall take precedence over ancillary offices.

Priority Four: The fourth level of priority can be categorized as recreational areas such as additional amenities such as drinking fountains located on or near playgrounds, park benches, and ballfields. Most of the playground facilities are owned and operated by the school department and shall be addressed within the respective accompanying plan of the Board of Education. Any ball fields or recreational spaces owned or operated by the county shall be improved to include accessible spaces for the public to enjoy and participate. These spaces shall be address during any schedule maintenance, repairs or improvements; however, priorities one-three shall take precedence.

It is the intent of the County to address those items listed as Priority One and Two within a time frame of one to four years depending on immediate necessity, complexity and funding. The County intends to address all concerns in a routine and timely manner to ensure accessibility to all its employees and citizens. Sullivan County does reserve the right to modify the implementation schedule depending on funding and resources. It is the intent of this plan to direct the ADA Coordinator to strive for full compliance in all renovation recommendations as well as to work in coordination with all department heads and elected officials.

SULLIVAN COUNTY ADA SELF-ASSESSMENT & EVALUATION PLAN BY PRIORITY/SCHEDULE

Anderson Townhouse:

The Anderson Townhouse log structure was built in 1792/1975 with the back portion added in 1825 and 1940s per the national Register of Historic Places documentation. In the fall of 2019, Sullivan County was awarded a preservation grant from the Tennessee Historical Commission to assist in the rehabilitation and repairs of the historical structure. Such repairs shall include the ADA Compliance recommendations as outlined below. The schedule for implementation shall be congruent with the grant program contract. Additional funding sources have been planned such as donations and county maintenance funds for historic buildings.

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Front Parking Lot not attainable	n/a – parking on street
1.13, 1.17	Remove pavers, pour concrete slab, new pavers	n/a – historic brick sidewalk
1.27, 1.28	Re-build wood ramp	2020
1.30, 1.31, 1.34, 1.35	New handrail at ramp	2020
1.36	Ramp curb	2020
1.37, 1.39, 1.40	Ramp in lieu of steps	2020
1.41	New front door 36' wide (not recommended)	2020
1.42	Re-configure walls (not recommended)	2021
1.43	New threshold	2020
1.44	New door hardware	2020
2.2	Interior ramp in lieu of steps	2021
2.4	Re-configure cabinetry	2022
2.4	Change door opening to 36"	2020
2.41	Re-configure walls (not recommended)	THC will need to approve
2.43	Replace knob with lever handle	2020

Archives & Heritage Tourism Building:

The Archives Office serves as a place for research and committee meetings. It was built in circa 1950. The interior space holds a large conference table that cannot be readily accessed to those with disabilities. Rearrangement of interior furnishing shall be top priority to ensure compliance. The exterior access is sufficient and suitable however the existing grade of the parking spaces located adjacent to the side façade of the structure follows the contour of the parcel of land the building and courthouse uses. The county shall designate an accessible spot closest to the door and restripe, pave and secure accordingly.

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3	Stripe parking lot	2024
1.4	Stripe parking lot	2024
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave at accessible spaces	2024
1.1	New accessible parking sign	2024
1.46	Adjust closer	2024
1.49	Secure edges of mats	2019
2.4, 2.47, 2.50	Re-configure furnishings	2024
2.67	Replace desk	2024

Asphalt Plant No.2 @ 639 Centenary Road, Blountville:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Striping	2026
1.17, 1.18	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2026
1.37	Main entrance not accessible - add sidewalk	2026
1.38	Add sidewalk	2026
1.43	Add ramp	2026
1.44	Re-bore and re-strike door and frame - add lever handle	2026
1.46	Replace closer	2026
2.1, 2.2, 2.8	Remove / re-organize furnishings	2026
2.9	Add personnel lift	2026
2.42	Reconstruct stairs and platform	2026
2.43	Re-bore and re-strike door and frame - add lever handle	2026
2.5	Relocate light switches - 3 each	2026
3.4	Remove / re-organize furnishings	2026
3.7	Re-configure Furnishings	2026
3.9	Re-bore and re-strike door and frame - add lever handle	2026
3.19	Mirror too high - remove and reinstall	2026
3.21, 3.26	Replace lavatory with accessible style	2026
3.29	Relocate paper towel and soap dispenser	2026
3.3	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2026
3.31	Relocate trash can	2026
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars	2026
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2026
4.10	Remove / re-organize furnishings	2026
4.2, 4.6, 4.7	Replace drinking fountain with accessible style	2026

Animal Shelter:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3	Re-stripe parking lot	2026
1.4	Stripe for van accessible	2026
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2026
1.9	No accessible route - add sidewalk	2026
1.1	Accessible parking signs	2026
1.1, 1.37, 1.38	Add accessible ramps leading to entrance	2026
1.41, 1.46	New front entrance door	2026
1.49	Secure edges of mat	2026
2.41	Re-configure walls	2026
2.41	Re-pour portion of concrete floor	2026
2.42	Replace threshold	2026
2.43	Replace doorknobs with lever handles	2026
2.5	Re-configure walls	2026
2.76	Re-work counter for height	2026
2.78	Re-work counter for knee space	2026

3.2	Add accessible toilet signs	2026
3.9	Replace doorknobs with lever handles	2026
3.28	Relocate soap dispenser	2026
3.3	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2026
3.32, 3.37	Replace water closet with accessible style	2026
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2026
4.6	Replace drinking fountain	2026

Bernie Webb Ballpark:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Add striping	2029
1.13, 1.17, 1.37, 2.3	Pave parking lot and entrance	2029
2.64	Add sections of bleachers to accommodate accessible - 4 each	2029
2.76	modify counter	2029
2.8	modify counter	2029
S1	Add sidewalk	2029
S2	Add sidewalk	2029
T1	Add sidewalk	2029
T2	Modify player seating - 4 each	2029

Bloomingdale Public Library:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3-1.7	Restripe accessible parking area	2028
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2028
1.1	New accessible sign	2028
1.14	Replace sidewalks	2028
1.16, 1.20, 1.21, 1.23	New concrete curb cut and ramp	2028
1.46	Adjust closer	2028
1.49	Secure edges of mats	2028
2.8	Relocate sign	2028
2.47, 2.68	Re-configure furniture, furnishings, equipment	2028
2.8	Re-work casework	2028
3.6	Increase door size to 36"	2028
3.7, 3.16-3.18, 3.31	Reconstruct single user toilet	2028
3.25	Replace lavatory with accessible style	2028
3.3	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2028
3.33, 3.34	Add or replace grab bars	2028
3.37	replace water closet	2028
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2028

Blountville Public Library:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3, 1.4	Strip Parking lot	2026
1.12	Improper slope - Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2026
2.43	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2026
2.50, 2.65	Re-configure furnishings	2026
2.67	Replace table	2026
2.76	Modify casework - height	2026
2.8	Modify casework - knee space	2026
3.5	New door sign - M & W	2026
3.7	Re-configure walls - M & W	2026
3.9	Replace doorknob with lever handle - M & W	2026
3.11, 3.12	Replace closer - M & W	2026
3.17	Re-configure walls	2026
3.30, 3.31	relocate water closet - M & W	2026
3.34	Add grab bars - M & W	2026
3.37	Replace water closet - M & W	2026
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser - M & W	2026
3.43, 3.47	Replace toilet compartments - M & W	2026
4.6	Relocate drinking fountain	2026

Bristol Justice Center (County owns half of the building/city owns the other half):

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.8, 1.12, 1.18	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave, re-stripe	2022-2023
1.1	Accessible parking signs	2022-2023
1.2	New curb cut and curb ramp	2022-2023
1.23	Relocate obstructions	2022-2023
1.23, 1.29, 1.42	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pour sidewalks	2022-2023
1.4	Accessible access signs	2022-2023
1.46	Replace door closer	2022-2023
1.49	Secure edge of floor mat	2022-2023
2.8	Remove protrusions in circulation path	2022-2023
2.13	Inadequate clear space at bottom of ramp - no solution	2022-2023
2.16	remove handrails, reinstall at proper height, patch	2022-2023
2.2	Handrail extensions	2022-2023
2.25	Elevator cab not proper size - Replace elevator and shaft	2022-2023
2.38	Room signs	2022-2023
2.4	Replace door with wider door	2022-2023
2.41	Re-configure walls	2022-2023
2.45, 2.46	Replace closer	2022-2023
2.5	Re-configure furnishings	2022-2023
2.5	Relocate switches and controls - 8 each	2022-2023

2.52	Re-work seating to accommodate wheelchairs - 4 locations	2022-2023
2.67	New defense table	2022-2023
2.76	Modify counters - 3 locations	2022-2023
2.78, 2.80	Modify casework - 4 locations	2022-2023
3.50	Non-compliant toilet signage - replace	2022-2023
3.11, 3.12	Re-place closers - 4 each	2022-2023
3.19	Mirrors mounted too high - remove and re-install - 4 each	2022-2023
3.20	Relocate coat hooks	2022-2023
3.27	Replace faucet	2022-2023
3.28	Relocate soap dispensers - 4 each	2022-2023
3.30	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2022-2023
3.31	Re-configure walls - 4 places	2022-2023
3.33, 3.34	Grab bars - 4 toilets	2022-2023
3.36	Replace flush valves - 3 toilets	2022-2023
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2022-2023
3.41, 3.42	Re-configure walls - 2 places	2022-2023
3.47	Replace toilet partitions to accommodate accessible - 4 toilets	2022-2023
4.90	Relocate drinking fountain	2022-2023

Colonial Heights Public Library

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.4	Inadequate Accessible Parking striping - Black-out and re-strip	2028
1.5	Inadequate Accessible Parking striping - Black-out and re-strip	2028
1.8	Inadequate slope at Accessible Parking - Cut out, re-grade, re-pave	2028
1.1	Accessible Parking Sign	2028
1.11	Accessible Parking Sign	2028
1.44	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2028
1.49	Secure floor mat edge	2028
2.38	Relocate door sign	2028
2.47	Re-configure equipment and furnishings	2028
2.5	Relocate light switches	2028
2.76	Lower section of counter	2028
2.8	Add knee space to counter	2028
3.5	Relocate door sign	2028
3.6	Increase door to 36" wide	2028
3.7, 3.17	Re-construct single user toilet	2028
3.9	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2028
3.26	Insulate pipes	2028
3.3	Water closet too close to wall - relocate	2028
3.33	Add or replace grab bars	2028
3.37	Change Water closet	2028
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2028
4.1	Replace drinking fountain	2028

Colonial Heights Recycling Center

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.1, 1.2, 1.12	Striping for route identifying and parking	2024

County Clerk's Office – Blountville:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3, 1.4	Blackout and re-stripe	2020
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave, re-stripe	2020
1.1	Accessible Parking Signs - 2 each	2020
1.18, 1.19	New curb cut and ramp	2020
1.42	cut-out floor and replace	2020
1.46	Adjust closer	2020
1.49	Secure edges of mats	2020
2.38	Replace door sign	2020
2.41	cut-out floor and replace	2020
2.45	replace closers - 2 each	2020
2.5	Relocate furnishings and equipment	2020
2.5	relocate light switches - 8 each	2020
2.76	Counters too high in 3 places	2020
2.8	Counters requiring knee space	2020

County Maintenance Building – Blountville:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Stripe parking Lot for Accessible spaces	2026
1.17	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave at accessible spaces	2026
1.42	Re-configure walls - 2 locations	2026
1.43	Replace threshold	2026
1.44	Replace 3 doorknobs with lever handles	2026
1.47	Re-configure walls	2026
1.49	Secure edge of mats 3 places	2026
2.8	Move obstructions	2026
2.42	Replace threshold	2026
2.43	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2026
2.5	Re-configure walls	2026
2.52	Relocate Furnishings and equipment	2026
2.78	Re-configure walls and casework	2026
3.7	re-configure walls	2026
3.8	Replace threshold	2026
3.1	Replace knob with lever handle	2026
3.19	Remove and re-install mirror	2026
3.29	Remove and re-install towel dispenser	2026
3.32	Replace water closet with accessible style	2026

Election Offices – Blountville:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.46	Adjust closer	2020
1.49	Secure edges of floor mats	2020
2.42	Replace threshold at 2 doors	2020
2.45, 2.46	Replace closer at 5 doors	2020
2.5	Light switch at improper height at 5 locations	2020
2.54, 2.60	Re-configure furniture	2020
2.76	Modify Counter	2020
3.7	Re-configure walls at M & W	2020
3.11, 3.12	Replace closer at M & W	2020
3.29	Insulate pipes at M & W	2020
3.31, 3.44, 3.47	Re-configure toilet compartments and replace with new at M & W	2020
3.33, 3.34	Add or replace grab bars at M & W	2020

Hickory Tree County Highway Department:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Striping	2025
1.17, 1.18	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2025
1.43	Replace threshold	2025
1.44	Replace door hardware	2025
1.46	Replace closer	2025
1.49	Secure edges of floor mat	2025
2.3	Apply epoxy grit to floor route	2025
2.41	Re-configure walls	2025
2.42	Replace threshold	2025
2.43	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2025
2.5	Relocate light switches - 4 each	2025
2.76, 2.80	Replace desk	2025
3.5	Proper toilet door sign	2025
3.7, 3.17	Re-configure walls	2025
3.9	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2025
3.18	Replace door with out-swinging	2025
3.19	Mirror too high - remove and reinstall	2025
3.21, 3.24, 3.25	Replace lavatory with accessible style	2025
3.28	Soap dispenser too high - relocate	2025
3.29	Paper towel dispenser too high - relocate	2025
3.3	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2025
3.36	Change flush valve	2025

Highway Dept. Shop and Storage:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Striping	2025
1.42	Reconfigure furnishing	2025
1.42	New entrance pad	2025
1.43	Replace threshold	2025
1.44	Re-bore and re-strike door and frame - add lever handle	2025
2.4	Replace door with wider 36"door	2025
2.43	Re-bore and re-strike door and frame - add lever handle	2025
2.5	relocate light switches - 3 each	2025
2.64	New table and chairs	2025
3.2, 3.5	Proper toilet signage	2025
3.6, 3.18, 3.21	Replace door with wider 36"door – out-swinging	2025
3.7, 3.16, 3.17	Re-configure walls	2025
3.9	Re-bore and re-strike door and frame - add lever handle	2025
3.19	Mirror too high - relocate	2025
3.22, 3.24, 3.25	Replace lavatory with accessible style	2025
3.27	Replace faucet with accessible style	2025
3.29	Towel dispenser too high - relocate	2025
3.30, 3.31	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2025
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars	2025
3.36	New flush valve	2025
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2025
4.2, 4.6	replace drinking fountain with accessible style	2025

Observation Knob Park (Campground/Recreational – leased from TVA)

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Black-out and re-stripe	2029
1.3, 1.4, 1.9	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2029
1.10, 1.11	New accessible parking signs	2029
1.12	Re-stripe and sign	2029
1.17, 1.18	New accessible route	2029
1.25, 1.27, 1.28	Reconstruct ramp	2029
1.3	Add ramp handrails - 4 sections	2029
1.37, 1.38, 1.39, 1.40	Main entrance not accessible - add sidewalk	2029
3.1, 3.2	Directional signs required	2029
3.4	Add accessible routes	2029
3.4	Reconstruct ramp	2029
3.5	Add proper signage	2029
3.6	Increase door opening	2029
3.7	Re-configure walls	2029
3.8	Replace thresholds	2029
3.9	Replace doorknobs with lever handles - 4	2029
3.16	Remove obstruction	2029

3.19	Mirrors too high - reinstall - 11 each	2029
3.2	Relocate coat hooks	2029
3.21	Remove obstructions - 5 places	2029
3.22, 3.23, 3.24	Replace lavatory with accessible style - 8 each	2029
3.25, 3.26	Insulate pipes - 10 each	2029
3.27	Replace faucet with accessible style - 10 each	2029
3.28	Relocate soap dispenser	2029
3.30	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate - 9 each	2029
3.31	Re-configure toilet compartments - 8 places	2029
3.32, 3.37	Replace water closet with accessible style - 10 each	2029
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars - 10 places	2029
3.38, 3.39, 3.40	Relocate toilet paper dispensers - 10 times	2029
3.41,3.42, 3.43, 3.44, 3.45, 3.47, 3.49, 3.50	New compliant toilet stalls - 11 each	2029
B1	Add ramp	2029
B11	Add railings	2029
P1, P2	Add sidewalks	2029
P35	Add compliant play component	2029
P37	Resurface	2029

Old Deery Inn:

The Old Deery Inn was constructed circa 1785 with additions made in 1801 and 1810 with additional log and brick ancillary structures on display behind the Inn. The structures and site are listed on the National Register of Historic Places and within the Historic Zoning District of Blountville. The county has received several grants through the Tennessee Department of Transportation for the restoration and preservation of the Inn and grounds as they are part of the Great Stage Road Museum and Walking Tour. The sidewalks and entrances were approved by TDOT in 2002 as part of the preservation plans. In order to preserve the historical integrity of this and other historic structures within the district owned by the county, while ensuring access to the facilities and historical experience of the sites, the Sullivan County Historic Preservation Association provides a video center located in the Community Room of the Rutledge House. The SCHPA members operate and manage the historical structures and sites and make every effort to accommodate those in need of access. The ground level of each structure is accessible as well as the grounds and park.

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.17	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	N/A
1.18, 1.20, 1.37, 1.38, 1.42	Re-construct front sidewalk/ ramp	2028
1.43	Add "ramp type" thresholds	Approved per Grant 2010
1.44, 1.45	New door hardware - Historically not recommended	
1.49	Secure edges of mats	2020
2.2, 2.6	Historically no solution	
2.38	Room signs - Historically not recommended	
2.4	Widen door to 36" - Historically not recommended	
2.41	Re-configure walls - Historically not recommended	
2.43	New door hardware - Historically not recommended	

2.50, 2.51	Relocate switches and controls – historically not recommended	
3.6	Widen door - Historically not recommended	
3.7	Re-configure walls - Historically not recommended	
3.9, 3.10	New door hardware - Historically not recommended	
3.18	Re-configure walls - Historically not recommended	
3.32	Replace water closet with accessible style	Accommodation on ground level of Community Room

Old Sheriff's Home/Jail – Sullivan County Heritage Information Center:

The Old Sheriff's Home/Jail was built in 1870 and is part of the National Register of Historic Places as well as within the Blountville Historic Zoning District. The County received several TDOT Enhancement Grants to restore the structure for adaptive reuse as the new Sullivan County Heritage Information Center. The grant project was completed in the winter of 2018 and opened in 2019. The striping for accessible parking and signage was completed in August 2019 – after the ADA Self-Assessment Study. Therefore, no additional modifications for this structure shall be made. The second floor is used for storage of rotating historical artifacts and display features and shall not be used for public offices or public meetings as there is no internal elevator to the second floor due to preserving the historical integrity of this 3-brick thick wall building. The Tourism Director shall make accommodations to visitors on the ground floor with video displays in the lobby. The primary entrance shall be the north facing door adjacent to the parking area. The front door facing the courthouse, shall not be used for guests due to the stairs.

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Stripe for accessible parking spaces	2019
1.1	Accessible parking signs	2019
1.42	Re-configure walls	Historic structure, 3 and 4 brick thick structural walls
	Renovation Ongoing - Re-evaluate after completion	**2019 - completed**

Public Defenders Building

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3, 1.4	Re-stripe Accessible Parking	2024
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2024
1.1	Accessible Parking Signs	2024
1.17	Replace accessible route	2024
1.43	Replace Threshold	2024
1.49	Secure edges of floor mat	2024
2.43	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2024
2.5, 3.7	re-configure furnishing	2024
2.8	Modify counter	2024
3.5	Proper toilet sign	2024
3.9	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2024
3.19	Remove and reinstall mirror	2024
3.23	Lavatory too high - remove, replumb, reinstall	2024

3.27	Replace Faucet with accessible style	2024
3.29	Towel dispenser too high - relocate	2024
3.3	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2024
3.33, 3.34	Replace or add grab bars	2024
3.36	Replace flush valve	2024
3.47	Replace toilet stall	2024
4.7	Replace water fountain	2024
		2024

Rutledge House/Community Room:

The historic Rutledge House was built in circa 1800. It is a two=story vernacular log dwelling with wood clapboard siding. The County received a TDOT Enhancement grant to restore this structure for the purpose of serving as a community room with a full working kitchen. The restoration was completed in 2009 per TDOT specifications.

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.43	Replace threshold– historically not recommended	2029
2.4	Replace door with wider door – historically not recommended	2029
2.41	Re-configure walls– historically not recommended	2029
2.42	Replace threshold– historically not recommended	2029
2.45, 2.46	Replace Closer - 2 each	2029
2.5	Replace light switch to proper location	2029
3.7	Reconfigure walls– historically not recommended	2029
3.11, 3.12	Replace Closer - 2 each	2029
3.17, 3.18	Re-construct single user toilet	2029
3.2	Relocate coat hooks	2029
3.24	Re-set lavatory	2029
3.26	Insulate pipes	2029
3.3	water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2029
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars	2029
3.36, 3.37	Flush control on wrong side of water closet - change	2029
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser - 2 each	2029
3.43	New toilet partitions - 2 each	2029
4.1	Relocate water fountain	2029

Snow House

The historic Snow House was built in circa 1900 according to the National Register of Historic Places documentation. The Snow House is used by the county for offices. It is a two-story Folk Victorian frame house.

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.35	Handrail extensions	2025
1.42	Re-arrange furniture	2025
1.43	Add a "ramp type" threshold	2025
1.46	Adjust closer	2025
1.49	Secure edges of mat	2025

2.41	Re-configure walls	2025
2.42	Replace threshold	2025
2.43	Replace door hardware	2025
2.5	Relocate light switch to proper height	2025
2.78 - 2.80	Modify counter	2025
3.7, 3.17, 3.21	Re-construct single user toilet	2025
3.9	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2025
3.26	Insulate pipes	2025
3.28	Relocate soap dispenser	2025
3.29	Replace paper towel dispenser	2025
3.3	Water closet too far from wall - relocate	2025
3.32	replace water closet with accessible style	2025
3.33	Replace and add grab bars	2025

Sullivan County Historic Courthouse:

The original courthouse was built in 1853 and rebuilt in 1866 after the interior was burned during the Battle of Blountville in the Civil War. There is a 1953 side and rear addition. The historic courthouse is Greek Revival-style.

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3	Black-out and re-stripe accessible parking spaces - 2 locations	2021-2022
1.7	Black-out and re-stripe accessible parking spaces - 2 locations	2021-2022
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2021-2022
1.9	Add accessible route	2021-2022
1.10, 1.11	Proper accessible parking signs	2021-2022
1.17	Re-slope ramp	2021-2022
1.18	Re-construct ramp	2021-2022
1.39, 1.40	Install accessible signs - 2 locations	2021-2022
1.42	Replace floor	2021-2022
1.46	Adjust closer	2021-2022
1.49	Secure edges of floor mat	2021-2022
2.7	Add topping and refinish	2021-2022
2.8	Remove drinking fountain and steps	2021-2022
2.15, 2.16, 2.19, 2.20	Add grip-able handrail to both sides	2021-2022
2.25, 2.29, 2.31	Replace elevator and shaft	2021-2022
2.38	Replace room signs	2021-2022
2.4	Replace doors with 36" wide doors - 5 times	2021-2022
2.41	Re-configure walls - 6 places	2021-2022
2.42	Replace thresholds - 2 places	2021-2022
2.45, 2.46	Adjust or replace closers - 10 each	2021-2022
2.47	Re-configure furnishings	2021-2022
2.5	Relocate light switches - 7 each	2021-2022
2.68	Re-configure furnishings	2021-2022
2.76, 2.78, 2.80	Modify counters and casework	2021-2022
3.2	Toilet directional sign	2021-2022

3.5	Re-configure walls and replace door Proper toilet door sign - 3 each	2021-2022
3.6, 3.7	Replace closers - 3 each	2021-2022
3.11, 3.12	Replace toilet compartments	2021-2022
3.15, 3.16	Remove and reinstall mirror	2021-2022
3.19	relocate coat hooks - 3 each	2021-2022
3.20	Replace lavatory with accessible style	2021-2022
3.24	Insulate pipes - 3 locations	2021-2022
3.26	Replace towel dispensers - 3 each	2021-2022
3.29	2 water closets not proper distance from wall - relocate	2021-2022
3.30	Reconfigure toilet compartments - 2	2021-2022
3.31	Replace water closet with accessible style	2021-2022
3.32	Add grab bars - 3 locations	2021-2022
3.33, 3.34	Replace flush valves - 3 locations	2021-2022
3.36, 3.37	Re-configure toilet compartments	2021-2022
3.41, 3.42, 3.47, 3.50	Replace 2 water fountains with accessible style	2021-2022
4.1, 4.6, 4.9	Rework service counter	2021-2022
	Rework service counter	2021-2022

Sullivan County EMA building:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.37, 1.43	Remove exterior entrance and replace	2027
1.46	Replace door closer	2027
2.2, 2.9	Not accessible to interior floors - Add elevator and shaft	2027
2.38	Add new door signs - 9 each	2027
2.4	Increase door width to 36" - 5 each	2027
2.41	Re-configure furnishings	2027
2.43	Replace doorknobs with lever handles - 4 each	2027
2.45, 2.46	Replace door closers - 3 each	2027
2.5	Re-configure furnishings	2027
2.64, 2.65	Re-configure furnishings	2027
3.5	Replace toilet signs	2027
3.6	Replace toilet doors with 36" wide	2027
3.7, 3.16, 3.17, 3.18, 3.21, 3.31, 3.49	Reconstruct Toilets	2027
3.9	Change door hardware	2027
3.11, 3.12	New door closers	2027
3.19	Remove and reinstall mirrors	2027
3.26	Insulate pipes	2027
3.27	Replace faucet with accessible style	2027
3.3	Water closet not proper distance from wall - Relocate	2027
3.32, 3.36	replace water closet with accessible style	2027
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars - 2 sets	2027
3.38	Toilet paper dispenser remove and relocate	2027

Sullivan County EMS:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3	Stripe parking spaces	2027
1.4	Stripe parking spaces	2027
1.1	Accessible parking sign	2027
1.27	Replace accessible ramp - Improper slope	2027
1.3	Add handrail to wall side of ramp	2027
1.31	Replace handrail to outside of ramp	2027
1.42	Re-configure walls	2027
1.46	Adjust closer	2027
1.49	Secure mats	2027
2.5	Re-configure walls	2027
2.68	Re-configure furniture and equipment	2027
3.5	Proper door signs for M & W	2027
3.6	Replace doors with 36" wide M & W	2027
3.9	Replace doorknobs with lever handles M & W	2027
3.17, 3.31	Re-construct single user toilet	2027
3.19	remove & install mirror	2027
3.21	Remove lavatory and replace with accessible style M & W	2027
3.27	Replace faucet M & W	2027
3.29	Relocate Towel dispenser M & W	2027
3.3	Relocate water closet M & W	2027
3.32	Replace water closet with accessible style M & W	2027
3.33, 3.34	Add or replace grab bars M & W	2027
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser M & W	2027
3.41, 3.47, 3.49	Re-configure and replace with new toilet compartments M & W	2027

Sullivan County Health Department – Blountville/Main Office:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3	Re-stripe parking	2024
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2024
1.1	Add accessible parking signs	2024
1.2	New curb cut and ramp	2024
1.23, 1.24	Replace sidewalk	2024
1.42	replace entrance pad	2024
1.49	Secure edges of floor mats	2024
2.8	Relocate drop box	2024
2.38	Replace signs - 6 each	2024
2.41	Re-configure furnishings	2024
2.41	Re-configure walls	2024
2.45	Adjust or replace closers	2024
2.5	Re-configure furniture	2024
2.51	Relocate wall switches to proper height - 8 each	2024
2.76	Modify counter	2024

3.5	New toilet door sign	2024
3.7	Relocate equipment	2024
3.11, 3.12	Replace closers	2024
3.15	Re-configure walls	2024
3.17	Re-configure walls	2024
3.19	Remove and reinstall mirror	2024
3.2	Relocate coat hooks	2024
3.26	Insulate pipes - 3 each	2024
3.27	Replace faucet with accessible style	2024
3.29	Replace paper towel dispenser	2024
3.31	Re-configure walls	2024
3.32	Replace water closet with accessible style	2024
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars	2024
3.43, 3.44	Replace compartment doors - 3 each	2024

Sullivan County Justice Center:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2, 1.4, 1.5, 1.7	Striping	2020
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2020
1.9	Add accessible route - sidewalk	2020
1.1	New and proper accessible parking signs	2020
1.18, 1.28	Re-construct level landing	2020
1.19	New curb cut and ramp	2020
1.3	Add handrails to ramp	2020
1.42	Remove obstruction	2020
1.46	Adjust closer	2020
2.8	Remove drinking fountain and patch	2020
2.25	Re-configure walls	2020
2.29	Replace elevator control panel	2020
2.31	Replace elevator sign	2020
2.32	Replace 2 door signs	2020
2.40, 2.41	Remove obstructions - 6 places	2020
2.41	Grind floor	2020
2.42	Replace threshold	2020
2.43	Replace doorknob with lever handle - 3 each	2020
2.45, 2.46	Adjust closer - 10 each	2020
2.5	Relocate light switch to proper height - 11 each	2020
2.5	Remove obstructions - 11 places	2020
2.52	Re-configure seating to accommodate wheelchairs in 3 courtrooms	2020
2.76	Modify counter - 4 each	2020
2.80	Modify counter - 4 each	2020
3.50	Proper toilet door signs - 4 each	2020
3.70	Re-configure walls - 3 locations	2020
3.11, 3.12	Adjust closers - 3 each	2020

3.26	Insulate pipes - 4 toilets	2020
3.28	Soap dispenser too high - relocate - 2 places	2020
3.30	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate - 3 each	2020
3.31, 3.41, 3.47	Reconfigure toilet compartments - 2 each	2020
3.33, 3.34	Add or relocate grab bars - 4 toilets	2020
3.37	New flush valve	2020
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispensers - 4 each	2020
3.43, 3.44	Stall door hardware - 4 each	2020
4.2, 4.5	Replace drinking fountain with accessible style - 2 locations	2020

Sullivan County Transfer Station 1 @ 804 Raytheon Road, Bristol:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Striping	2024
1.13	Paving	2024
2.1	Add accessible route	2024
2.76	Lower service window or add ramp and platform	2024

Sullivan County Transfer Station 2 @ 1921 ½ Brookside Lane, Kingsport:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Striping	2024
1.13	Add paving	2024
1.37	Main entrance not accessible - add sidewalks	2024
2.38	Add proper signage	2024
2.5	Replace light switch	2024
2.76	Lower service window or add ramp and platform	2024
3.1, 3.4	Move furnishings	2024
3.5	Proper signage	2024
3.6	Replace door with 36" wide	2024
3.7	Re-configure walls	2024
3.8	Replace thresholds	2024
3.9, 3.10	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2024
3.16, 3.17	Re-configure walls	2024
3.19	Mirror too high - remove and reinstall	2024
3.21, 3.25	Re-configure piping and reinstall lavatory	2024
3.26	Insulate pipes	2024
3.27	Replace faucet with accessible style	2024
3.29	Relocate hand dryer	2024
3.31	Re-configure walls	2024
3.32, 3.37	Replace water closet with accessible style	2024
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars	2024

Sullivan Gardens Public Library:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.3, 1.4	Black-out and re-stripe parking	2028
1.1	Accessible parking signs	2028
1.46	Replace closer	2028
1.49	Secure edges of floor mat	2028
2.47	re-configure furnishings	2028
2.5	Re-locate door	2028
2.76	Modify counter	2028
2.8	Modify casework	2028
3.16, 3.7	Re-configure walls	2028
3.19	Mirror too high - remove and reinstall	2028
3.22, 3.24, 3.25	Replace lavatory with accessible style	2028
3.29	Towel dispenser too high - relocate	2028
3.3	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2028
3.31	Re-configure walls	2028
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2028

Sullivan House (Archive Dept, Storage):

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.4	Black-out, Re-stripe parking	2025
1.8	Cut-out, re-grade, re-pave	2025
1.1	Accessible parking Signs - 2 each	2025
1.17	New accessible route	2025
1.37	Add ramp at entrance	2025
1.42	Re-configure entrance pad and doors	2025
1.46, 2.46	Replace closers - 4 each	2025
1.49	Secure edges of floor mats	2025
2.41	doors lack clearance - reconfigure walls	2025
2.42	Replace thresholds	2025
2.43	Replace doorknobs with lever handles - 9 each	2025
2.44	Replace hardware	2025
2.5	Relocate switches	2025
3.2, 3.3	Accessible toilet signs - 9 each	2025
3.6	Replace doors with wider 36' door - 5 each	2025
3.7	Reconfigure walls - 3 places	2025
3.11, 3.12	Replace closers - 3 each	2025
3.16, 3.17	Re-hang lavatories - 3 each	2025
3.19	Remove and reinstall Mirrors	2025
3.21	Reconfigure door	2025
3.24	replace lavatories with accessible style - 3 each	2025
3.26	Insulate pipes	2025
3.28	Relocate soap dispenser	2025
3.29	Relocate paper towel dispensers - 4 each	2025

3.30	Water closet not proper distance from wall - relocate	2025
3.31 - 3.50	Reconfigure toilet compartments - 5 places	2025
3.32	Replace water closet with accessible style - 3 each	2025
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars - 5 toilets	2025
3.37	Flush controls on wrong side - change 4 closets	2025
4.2, 4.7	Replace drinking fountain	2025

Thomas Memorial Public Library – Bluff City (owned by county):

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.2	Striping	2028
1.1	Accessible parking signs	2028
1.28	Place pad at toe of ramp	2028
1.3	Remove protruding objects from pathway	2028
1.30, 1.34, 1.36	Add or replace handrails	2028
1.49	Secure edges of floor mat	2028
2.13, 2.14	Remove obstructions from pathway	2028
2.15, 2.16, 2.17, 2.19, 2.21	Replace handrails at interior ramps	2028
2.5	Relocate light switch to proper height	2028
2.76	modify counter	2028
2.8	modify counter	2028
3.5	Proper door sign	2028
3.7	Re-configure walls	2028
3.11, 3.12	Replace closer	2028
3.19	Mirrors too high - remove and reinstall	2028
3.26	Insulate pipes	2028
3.31, 3.47	Re-configure toilet compartment	2028
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars	2028
3.37	Replace water closet	2028
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2028
3.5	Re-configure walls	2028
4.2, 4.6	Replace drinking fountain	2028

Sullivan County EMS Station 5 @ 2030 Hickory Tree Road, Bluff City:

PRIORITY #	DEFICIENCY	SCHEDULE
1.42	Move obstructions	2024
1.44	Re-bore and re-strike door and frame - add lever handle	2024
2.5	Re-configure furnishings	2024
2.64, 2.66, 2.67	Replace table with accessible style	2024
3.7	Replace shower with wider accessible style	2024
3.9	Replace doorknob with lever handle	2024
3.15, 3.16, 3.17, 3.18	Re-configure walls	2024
3.2	Relocate coat hook	2024

3.22, 3.24, 3.25	Replace lavatory with accessible style	2024
3.28	Soap dispenser too high - relocate	2024
3.29	Paper towel dispenser too high - relocate	2024
3.31	Relocate wall	2024
3.32	Replace water closet with accessible style	2024
3.33, 3.34	Add grab bars	2024
3.38	Relocate toilet paper dispenser	2024

APPENDICES

Appendix A – Standard Definitions:

As used in this Transition Plan Update, the following terms shall have the meaning ascribed to them in this Section, which are consistent with the provisions of existing federal and state law, including the regulations promulgated there under. Except to the extent expressly stated to the contrary, any term not expressly defined in this Section or elsewhere in this Transition Plan that has an expressly defined meaning in either the ADA or the regulations promulgated there under ("Regulations") shall have the meaning ascribed to it by the ADA or the Regulations, in that order of preference. All other terms shall be interpreted according to their plain and ordinary meaning.

ADA: "ADA" means and refers to the Americans with Disabilities Act as contained at 42 U.S.C. §12101 et seq.

ADAAG: "ADAAG" means and refers to the Americans with Disabilities Act Access Guidelines of 2010, codified at Appendix A to 28 Code of Federal Regulations Part 36 and at Appendix A to 49 Code of Federal Regulations part 37. "ADAAG Standards" means and refers to physical conditions that meet the new construction and/or alterations standards set forth in the ADAAG guidelines. Note Sullivan County subscribes to ADAAG and not the Uniform Federal Accessibility Standards ("UFAS").

Auxiliary Aids and Services: The term "auxiliary aids and services" includes, qualified interpreters or other effective methods of making orally delivered materials available to individuals with hearing impairments; qualified readers, taped texts, or other effective methods of making visually delivered materials available to individuals with visual impairments; and acquisition or modification of equipment or devices; and other similar services and actions.

Compliance Period: "Compliance Period" means and refers to the period for which this Transition Plan will be in effect. The Transition Plan shall become effective upon Approval of the County Commission and may remain in effect for up to 30 years. The County may dissolve the Transition Plan at any time upon a showing that is in full compliance or upon a showing that it has met or exceeded the monetary obligations specified in this Transition Plan. Alternatively, the Transition Plan will remain in effect until it dissolves automatically 30 years after Approval of the County Commission.

Compliant Curb Ramp: "Compliant Curb Ramp" means and refers to a curb ramp that is constructed to comply with state and/or federal law (whichever provides the higher access standard) in place at the time of construction. In the case of a location where it is Structurally Impracticable or Technically Infeasible to build a fully compliant curb ramp, or where construction of a fully compliant curb ramp would constitute a Fundamental Alteration of a service, program, or activity of the County or an Undue Burden on the County, a curb ramp that complies with access standards, or was constructed to the standards existing at the time of construction, or to the maximum extent feasible, will constitute a Compliant Curb Ramp as long as the requirements set forth in this Transition Plan for justifying the reasons for the County to avoid full compliance are met.

Curb Ramp: "Curb Ramp" is used interchangeably with "curb cut."

Detectable Warnings: "Detectable Warnings" means and refers to truncated domes which provide a tactile surface at the transition between the curb and the street or other hazardous vehicular crossings, assisting pedestrians with Vision Disabilities in determining when there may be the threat of vehicular traffic.

Disability: "Disability" means, with respect to an individual, a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits or just limits one or more of the major life activities of such individual; a record of such impairment; or being regarded as having such impairment.

Discrimination on the Basis of Disability: "Discrimination on the Basis of Disability" means to, limit, segregate, or classify a citizen in a way that may adversely affect opportunities or status because of the person's disability; limit, segregate, or classify a participant in a program or activity offered to the public in a way that may adversely affect opportunities or status because of the participant's disability; participate in a contract that could subject a qualified citizen with a disability to discrimination; use any standards, criteria, or methods of administration that have the effect of discriminating on the basis of disability; deny equal benefits because of a disability; fail to make reasonable accommodations to known physical or mental limitations of an otherwise qualified individual unless it can be shown that the accommodation would impose an undue burden on the County's operations; use selection criteria that exclude otherwise qualified people with disabilities from participating in the programs or activities offered to the public; and fail to use tests, including eligibility tests, in a manner that ensures that the test results accurately reflect the qualified applicant's skills or aptitude to participate in a program or activity.

Fundamental Alteration: "Fundamental Alteration" means and refers to an action that, if taken by the County, would result in a fundamental alteration in the nature of the service, program or activity of the County. If the County claims that any action otherwise required by this Transition Plan would constitute a Fundamental Alteration, the County shall have to demonstrate that such alteration would result. The decision that an action would constitute a Fundamental Alteration must be made by the ADA Coordinator and the county maintenance department, or his or her designee, after considering all funds and alternatives available and must be accompanied by a written statement of the reasons for reaching that conclusion.

Mobility Disability: "Mobility Disability" means and refers, with respect to an individual, to any physical or mental impairment or condition that substantially limits an individual's ability to move his or her body or a portion of his or her body and includes, but is not limited to, orthopedic and neuromotor disabilities and any other impairment or condition that limits an individual's ability to walk, maneuver around objects, ascend or descend steps or slopes and operate controls. An individual with a Mobility Disability may use a wheelchair or motorized scooter for mobility or may be Semi-Ambulatory.

Pedestrian Rights-of-Way: "Pedestrian Rights-of-Way" (PROW) means and refers to all sidewalks over which Sullivan County has responsibility or authority as well as all Curb Ramps and crosswalks serving such sidewalks and any other pathways used by pedestrians along public rights-of-way, including pedestrian pathways through public parking lots.

Physical or Mental Impairments: "Physical or mental impairments" may include, but are not limited to vision, speech, and hearing impairments; emotional disturbance and mental illness; seizure disorders; mental retardation; orthopedic and neuromotor disabilities; learning disabilities; diabetes; heart disease; nervous conditions; Cancer; Asthma; Hepatitis B; HIV infection/conditions; and drug addiction if the addict has successfully completed or is participating in a rehabilitation program and no longer uses illegal drugs. The following conditions are not physical or mental impairments: transvestitism; illegal drug use; homosexuality or bisexuality; compulsive gambling; kleptomania; pyromania; pedophilia; exhibitionism; voyeurism; pregnancy; height; weight; eye color; hair color; left-handedness; poverty; lack of education; a prison record; and poor judgment or quick temper if not symptoms of a mental or physiological disorder.

Qualified Individual with a Disability: "Qualified Individual with a Disability" means an individual with a disability who, with or without reasonable modification to rules, policies, or practices; the removal of architectural, communication, or transportation barriers; or the provision of auxiliary aids and services, meets the essential eligibility requirements for the receipt of services or the participation in programs or activities provided by the County.

Record of Impairment: An individual is disabled if he or she has a history of having an impairment that substantially limits the performance of a major life activity; or has been diagnosed, correctly or incorrectly, as having such impairment.

Regarded as Having a Disability: An individual is disabled if she or he is treated or perceived as having an impairment that substantially limits major life activities, although no such impairment exists.

Statutory Defenses: "Statutory Defenses" means and refers to the County's right to assert under this Transition Plan that removal of any barrier or installation of a Compliant Curb Ramp is not required because such barrier removal or curb ramp installation would be Technically Infeasible, or Structurally Impracticable, or that it would constitute an Undue Burden or Fundamental Alteration.

Structurally Impracticable: "Structurally Impracticable" means and refers to circumstances in which the unique characteristics of terrain prevent the incorporation of accessibility features. If it is structurally impracticable to provide full access at any location along pedestrian rights-of-way, the County shall comply with access requirements to the extent that it is not structurally impracticable to do so. (See ADAAG § 4.1.1(5)(a)).

Substantial Limitations of Major Life Activities: An individual is disabled if she or he has a physical or mental impairment that (a) renders her or him unable to perform a major life activity, or (b) substantially limits the condition, manner, or duration under which she or he can perform a particular major life activity in comparison to others.

Major life activities are functions such as caring for oneself, performing manual tasks, walking, seeing, hearing, speaking, breathing, learning, and working. In determining whether a physical or mental impairment substantially limits the condition, manner, or duration under which an individual can perform a particular major life activity in comparison to other people, the following factors shall be considered: The nature and severity of the impairment; The duration or expected duration of the impairment; and the permanent or long-term impact (or expected impact) of or resulting from the impairment.

Technically Infeasible: "Technically Infeasible" means, with respect to an alteration of a building, facility or Pedestrian Rights-of-Way, that it has little likelihood of being accomplished because existing physical or site constraints or a lack of public right of way prohibit modification or addition of elements, spaces, or features which are in full and strict compliance with the minimum requirements for new construction and which are necessary to provide accessibility. (See ADAAG § 4.1.6(1)(j)).

Third Party Entity: "Third-Party Entity" means an entity other than Sullivan County that controls certain barriers or elements of barriers in a Pedestrian Rights-of-Way. Transit agencies and local utilities are examples of Third-Party Entities.

Undue Burden: "Undue Burden" means and refers to an action that, if taken by Sullivan County, would result in an undue financial and administrative burden. In order to demonstrate that removal of a barrier would constitute an Undue Burden, the decision must be made by the ADA Coordinator and the county maintenance department, or his or her designee, after considering all resources available from various funding sources for removal of barriers and must be accompanied by a written statement of said reasons for reaching that conclusion. In preparing such a statement, the County may consider the usability of the existing facilities.

Appendix B – Resolution:

787

Sullivan County
Board of County Commissioners
239th Annual Session

Item 13
No. 2019-10-86

To the Honorable Richard S. Venable, Sullivan County Mayor and the Board of Sullivan County Commissioners meeting in Regular Session this 17th day of October 2019.

RESOLUTION): Be it resolved that Sullivan County, Tennessee shall not discriminate against qualified individuals with disabilities in the area of services, facilities, programs or activities and hereby adopts the American with Disabilities Self-Assessment and Transition Plan to ensure ADA compliance.

WHEREAS, Sullivan County, Tennessee has completed a self-evaluation of all county-owned, operated and leased facilities, which was completed in November of 2018 as required by the American with Disabilities Act (ADA) of 1990; and

WHEREAS, Sullivan County appointed an ADA Coordinator and Grievance Committee per the Grievance Policies for the county; and

WHEREAS, the next step in complying with the American with Disabilities Act of 1990 is to adopt an ADA Transition Plan for Sullivan County; and

WHEREAS, that the **ADA Transition Plan** be adopted and implemented as outlined in the plan. A copy of the entire Transition Plan and Self-Assessment Evaluation documents shall be preserved in the Office of the ADA Coordinator within the Sullivan County Maintenance Office; and

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the Board of County Commissioners hereby adopts the **ADA Transition Plan** for Sullivan County as required by the American with Disabilities Act of 1990.

This resolution shall take effect from and after its passage. All resolutions in conflict herewith be and the same rescinded insofar as such conflict exists.

Approved this 17th day of October, 2019.

Attest: Teresa Jacobs, County Clerk

Approved: Richard S. Venable, County Mayor

Sponsored By: Commissioner John Gardner
Co-Sponsor(s): Commissioner(s) Larry Crawford
2019-10 86 ACTIONS: 10/8/19 – Executive took no action; 10/8/19 – Administrative took no action; 10/17/19 – Approved on Consent 22 Yes, 2 Absent

Appendix C – Glossary of Terms and Acronyms:

The following terms have been defined to provide additional context and understanding for the reader.

Accessible Route A continuous unobstructed path connecting all accessible elements and spaces of a building or facility. Interior accessible routes may include corridors, floors, ramps, elevators, lifts, and clear floor space at fixtures. Exterior accessible routes may include parking access aisles, curb ramps, crosswalks at vehicular ways, walks, ramps, and lifts.

ADA Americans with Disabilities Act

ADAAG Americans with Disabilities Act Accessibility Guidelines

Disabled Person A person with disabilities

PROWAG Public Rights of Way Accessibility Guidelines

Public Right-of-Way Public land or property, usually interconnected corridors, which is acquired for or dedicated to transportation purposes

Cross Slope The slope that is perpendicular to the direction of travel.

Running Slope, the slope that is parallel to the direction of travel.

Ramp A walking surface which has a running slope greater than 1:20.

Curb Ramp A short ramp cutting through a curb or built up to it.

Automatic Door A door equipped with a power-operated mechanism and controls that open and close the door automatically upon receipt of a momentary actuating signal. The switch that begins the automatic cycle may be a photoelectric device, floor mat, or manual switch. Detectable Warning Signs Mechanisms to notify disabled people of obstructions in path of travel

Site Arrival Points Locations including accessible parking spaces and accessible passenger loading zones, public transit stops located on sites, and pubic streets and sidewalks.

Appendix D – Excerpts from TCA and CTAS (Reference Material Sourced)

Title II Requirements

Tennessee Code Annotated
Tennessee Attorney General Opinions

Reference Number: CTAS-2034
Reference Number:
CTAS-2034

To be in compliance with Title II, State and local governments:

- May not refuse to allow an individual with a disability to participate in a service, program, or activity because of the disability.
- Must provide programs and services in an integrated setting, unless separate or different accommodations are needed for equal opportunity.
- Must eliminate unnecessary eligibility standards or rules that deny individuals with disabilities an equal opportunity to enjoy programs and services.
- Are required to make needed modifications to policies, practices, and procedures that deny equal access to individuals with disabilities unless doing so would result in a major change to the program.
- Must ensure effective communication by furnishing auxiliary aids and services unless doing so would result in an undue burden or change.
- May provide additional special benefits to individuals with disabilities.
- May not charge individuals with disabilities to cover the costs of changes needed to ensure nondiscriminatory treatment.
-
- Shall operate all programs so that they are readily accessible and usable by individuals with disabilities.

42 U.S.C. § 12132.

Under Title II, the definition of an individual with a disability is the same as already described under Title I. However, the definition of a qualified individual with a disability differs slightly.

Under Title II a qualified individual with a disability meets the essential eligibility requirements for the program or activity offered by a public entity.

Essential eligibility requirements vary depending on the program or activity. For some activities, like state licensing programs, there may be skills or performance requirements that are considered essential. Other activities may have minimal eligibility requirements.

42 U.S.C. § 12131(2).

Program Access under Title II

Tennessee Code Annotated
Tennessee Attorney General Opinions

Reference Number: CTAS-2036
Reference Number:
CTAS-2036

State and local governments—

- Must make sure buildings that house services, programs, and activities are accessible to individuals with disabilities.

- Need not remove physical barriers in existing buildings so individuals with disabilities can access programs if they provide an alternative method to provide the program such as—
    - Relocate the program/service to an accessible facility (example: moving a public information office from the third floor to the first floor).
    - Provide an aid or personal assistant to help the individual with disability obtain the service.
    - Provide the program/service at the individual's home or an alternate accessible site.

- May not carry an individual with a disability as a method of providing program access except in exceptional circumstances.

- Do not have to make any changes that will result in a fundamental alteration of the program or service or be an undue financial burden.

One of the purposes of the ADA is to integrate individuals with disabilities into the mainstream of society. For this reason, public entities should not offer separate programs for individuals with disabilities unless a separate program is necessary to ensure benefits and services are equally effective.

State and local governments cannot require an individual with a disability to accept a special accommodation or benefit if the individual chooses not to accept. Even if separate programs are offered, individuals with disabilities have the right to choose to participate in the regular program. 42 U.S.C. § 12182.

Communication under Title II

Tennessee Code Annotated
Tennessee Attorney General Opinions

Reference Number: CTAS-2037
Reference Number:
CTAS-2037

To ensure effective communications with individuals with disabilities, state and local governments must offer auxiliary aids when necessary. Auxiliary aids include—

- Qualified interpreters,
- Assistive listening headsets,

- Television captioning and decoders,
- Telecommunications devices for deaf persons (TDD's),
- Videotext displays,
- Readers,
- Taped texts,
- Brailed materials and
- Large print materials.

A public entity may not charge an individual with a disability for use of an auxiliary aid. Telephone emergency services, including 911, must provide direct access to individuals with speech or hearing impairments. Public entities do not have to make any changes that will result in a fundamental alteration of the program or service or be an undue financial burden.

Accessibility, Enforcement and Compliance

Tennessee Code Annotated
Tennessee Attorney General Opinions

Reference Number: CTAS-2038
Reference Number:
CTAS-2038

Accessibility

Public entities must ensure that newly constructed buildings are readily accessible to individuals with disabilities. When a building is altered, it must still be accessible to individuals with disabilities. While ADA does not require retrofitting of existing buildings to eliminate barriers, it does establish a high standard of accessibility for new buildings.

Public entities can choose between—

- The Uniform Federal Accessibility Standard (UFAS), established under the Architectural Barriers Act; or
- The Americans with Disability Act Accessibility Guidelines (ADAAG), adopted by the Department of Justice for places of public accommodation and commercial facilities covered under Title III of the ADA.

The elevator exemption for small buildings under the ADA Accessibility Guidelines do not apply to public entities under Title II.

Under Title II, if the start date for new construction is March 15, 2012 or after, the construction must comply with the 2010 Americans with Disabilities Act Standards for Accessible Design. The state of Tennessee adopted the 2010 Standards for Accessible Design for all public buildings constructed, enlarged, or substantially altered or repaired after July 1, 2012. T.C.A. 68-120-204.

Enforcement and Compliance

Private parties may file lawsuits to enforce their rights under Title II of the ADA. The remedies available are the same as under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act. Reasonable attorney's fees may be awarded to the prevailing party.

There are eight administrative agencies designated to handle complaints filed under Title II. They are—

Department of Agriculture
Department of Education
Department of Health and Human Services
Department of Housing and Urban Development
Department of Interior
Department of Justice
Department of Labor
Department of Transportation

Individuals may file a complaint with the appropriate administrative agency or with any federal agency that provides financial assistance to the program in question. Complaints may also be filed with the Department of Justice who will refer the complaint to the appropriate agency.

The address for the Department of Justice is—

Disability Rights Section
Civil Rights Division
U.S. Department of Justice
950 Pennsylvania Avenue, NW
Washington, D.C. 20530-0001

Complaints on behalf of a class of people are permitted. Complaints should be in writing, signed by the complainant or an authorized representative, and should contain the complainant's name, address, and describe the public entities discriminatory action.